

In analysing the film Fargo, I'd like to point out something that grabbed my attention before getting into the topic that I want to mainly focus on. I didn't know much about Fargo and started watching without any prior knowledge. When it claimed to be based on a true story at the beginning, it grabbed my interest even more. Fascinated and horrified by the events, I tried to find the real story and people behind Fargo, only to discover it was all fiction. It reminded me of our class discussion about the Sandman story. Discovering the fact that I was fooled, gave me a funny feeling that is quite hard to describe. I think I understand our discussion even better now.

In the movie Fargo I'd like to talk about the passive communication style in which the people of the city adapted and also point out the linguistic abilities of the characters in contrast to their character

Throughout the movie, the dialogue felt far from real conversations, with characters using understatement, sudden topic changes, and hiding their emotions. This passive communication style gives criminals an advantage, as they can manipulate language without needing to be clever. For instance, when Margie interrogates Jerry, he nervously comments on Marge's pregnancy, changing the topic very quickly. Despite this odd shift, Marge doesn't seem to find it strange as she starts talking about being pregnant which gives Jerry some time to think of an answer to her question. Marge doesn't seem to be bothered or suspicious of this sudden change of topic, and therefore doesn't suspect Jerry. This example highlights how passive communication allows criminals like Jerry to manipulate dialogue effortlessly. Despite the obvious diversion, Margie fails to recognize Jerry's attempt to obfuscate the truth. This demonstrates the effectiveness of passive communication in criminal encounters.

Another point of interest is the portrayal of dissatisfaction among the criminals, particularly exemplified through Grimsrud's minimalistic speech pattern. His use of short, simple words reflects his resigned attitude towards life and his circumstances.

The portrayal of Grimsrud's linguistic minimalism also helps the audience's understanding of the characters' motivations and emotional states, making the movie appear even more interesting.